

Web Development Practical

Personal Profile Page

Applied Programming for AI, June, 2025

Introduction

Welcome to your first web development practical! In this exercise, you will build a personal profile page using HTML and CSS, moreover, you'll also get a quick introduction to JavaScript. This activity will help you practice editing HTML content, applying CSS styles, and adding a touch of interactivity to your page.

This practical is designed as preparation for your main group project, which starts in Week 2, so be sure to familiarize yourself with these essential skills. Follow each step and feel free to get creative as you personalize your profile.

Getting Started

1. Download the starter code ZIP from Canvas and unzip it.
2. Open `index.html` and `styles.css` in your favorite code editor.

Tasks

Complete each step below in order. Each step builds your profile page and introduces new web development skills.

1. Change your name in `index.html` so it displays your full name.
2. Add your hobbies as a list using `<ul>`.
3. Add a paragraph describing your education background.
4. Add a new section for your favorite quote (use `<blockquote>`).
5. Insert a profile image, change its width and height, moreover add a 3px solid border around it.
6. Change the color of your name using CSS in `styles.css`.
7. Change the background color of the page.
8. Add a clickable link to the [VU Amsterdam website](#).
9. Add a red button that, when clicked, shows an alert with a custom message (use JavaScript's `alert()` and style the button).
10. Make your name bold and one hobby italic.
11. Add a CSS class to your hobbies list and give the items a different text color.
12. Use CSS to move your name to the middle of the page.

Expected Result

Your final page should look clean and clearly display your personal information, hobbies, education, quote, and the other required elements. See the step-by-step guide below for inspiration.

Submission Instructions

1. Take a screenshot of the final version of your website and upload it on Canvas.

Enjoy coding and make your profile page unique!

Step-by-Step Guide

This section will guide you through each step to create your personal profile page. For every task, you will find a clear goal, practical hints, and a screenshot to check your progress. Remember, these steps are meant to help you learn—don't hesitate to experiment with your own creative ideas along the way!

Step 1: Change Your Name

Goal: Display your full name at the top of the page as a heading.

Guidance: Open `index.html`. At the very top of the body, you will find an `<h1>` element with `id="name"`. Type your full name between the opening and closing tags.

After this step, your name should appear prominently at the top of your profile page.

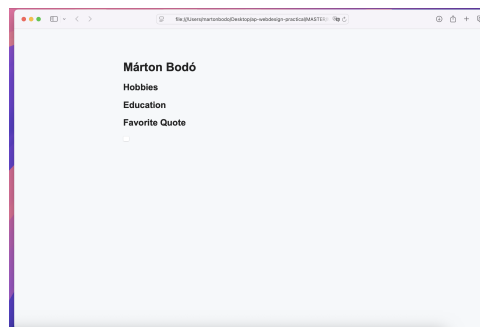


Figure 1: Step 1: The page now displays your name as a large heading.

Step 2: Add Your Hobbies as a List

Goal: Add a bulleted list of your hobbies to your profile.

Guidance: In `index.html`, scroll to the "Hobbies" section. Inside the existing `<ul>` element, create a class `hobbies` and add at least three hobbies as individual list items (`<li>`). You can customize your list items later with CSS.

After this step, your page will show a bulleted list of your hobbies.

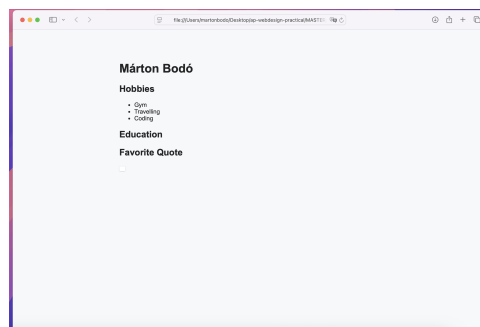


Figure 2: Step 2: Hobbies are now displayed as a list.

Step 3: Add a Paragraph for Your Education

Goal: Write a short paragraph about your education background.

Guidance: In `index.html`, scroll to the "Education" section. You will see a paragraph tag with `id="education"`. Write one or two sentences about your education between the opening and closing `<p>` tags.

After this step, your education background will appear under the "Education" heading.

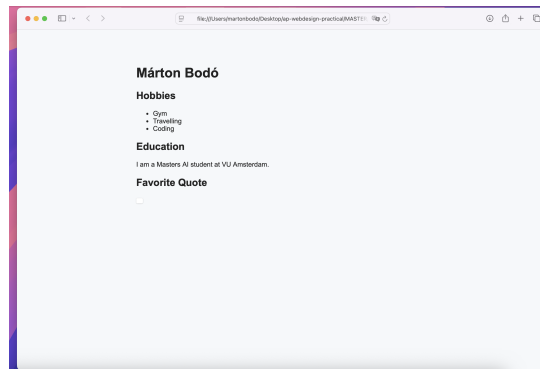


Figure 3: Step 3: A short education paragraph is shown on your page.

Step 4: Add a Section for Your Favorite Quote

Goal: Display your favorite quote on your profile using a suitable HTML tag.

Guidance: In `index.html`, locate the "Favorite Quote" section. There is a `<blockquote>` tag with `id="quote"`. Type your favorite quote between the opening and closing `<blockquote>` tags. (If you want, you can also mention who the quote is by, right after the quote.)

After this step, your favorite quote will appear styled as a quotation on your page.

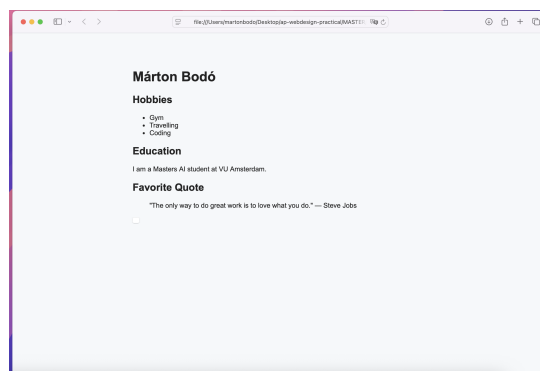


Figure 4: Step 4: Your favorite quote appears as a block quote.

Step 5: Add a Profile Image

Goal: Display your profile photo on the page and make it visually stand out.

Guidance: In `index.html`, place a profile image file (for example, `profile.jpg` or `profile.png`) in the same folder as your HTML file. Below your quote section, add

an `<img>` tag with a suitable `src` attribute and descriptive `alt` text. **Do not use any width or style attributes in the HTML!** Instead, assign your image an `id` (for example, `profile-pic`) so you can style it later in your CSS.

Once your image appears on the page, you can adjust its size and add a border using CSS in the next step. Try setting a maximum width and height, and experiment with adding a border to make the image pop.

After this step, your profile photo will appear on the page. In the next step, you'll style it further with CSS.

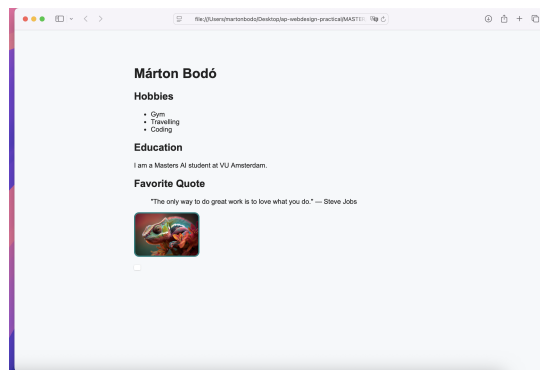


Figure 5: Step 5: Your profile image appears on the page.

Step 6: Change the Color of Your Name

Goal: Make your name stand out by changing its color using CSS.

Guidance: In `styles.css`, find or add a selector for your name's element (it should have `id="name"` in your HTML). Use the `color` property in CSS to choose a color you like for your name. You can use a named color (like `blue`), a hex code (like `#008080`), or an RGB value. After saving your CSS file, refresh your browser to see your name in the new color.

After this step, your name at the top of the page will appear in your chosen color.

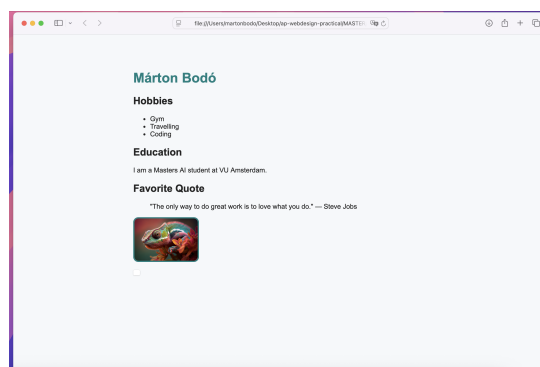


Figure 6: Step 6: Your name now appears with a custom color.

Step 7: Change the Background Color of the Page

Goal: Make your profile page more visually appealing by setting a custom background color.

Guidance: Open `styles.css`. Locate the CSS rule for the body selector. Find the property for `background` or `background-color`. Change its value to any color you like—a light pastel or soft color usually looks pleasant. You can use a named color (like `lightblue`), a hex code (like `#ffe4e1`), or an RGB value.

After this step, your entire page will have a new background color. Experiment to see what looks best!

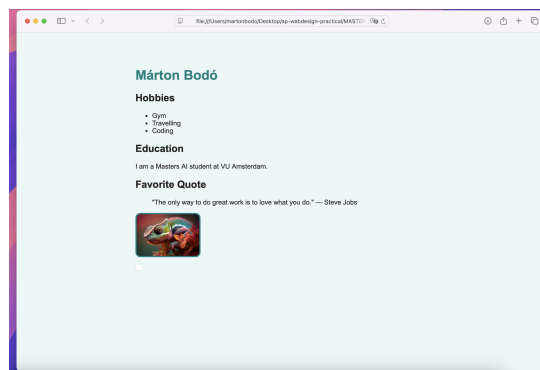


Figure 7: Step 7: The page background color has changed.

Step 8: Add a Link to the VU Amsterdam Website

Goal: Include a clickable link to the VU Amsterdam website on your profile page.

Guidance: In `index.html`, find the section below your profile image. Add an HTML link using the `<a>` tag so visitors can click through to the VU Amsterdam website. Remember to use the full URL (`https://www.vu.nl`) as the `href` attribute, and add a short, descriptive link text.

After this step, your profile page will have a clickable link to the VU Amsterdam website.

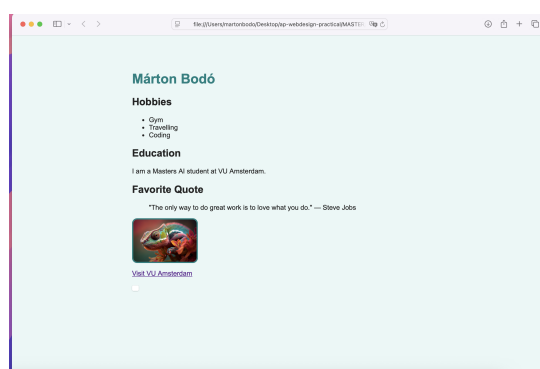


Figure 8: Step 8: A clickable link to the VU Amsterdam website is added.

Step 9: Add a Clickable Alert Button

Goal: Add a button to your profile page that, when clicked, displays an alert with a custom message.

Guidance: In `index.html`, below the VU Amsterdam link, add a `<button>` element. Give it an `id` (for example, `alert-btn`) for styling, and add a label like “Click Me!”. Next, in your `<script>` section, write a JavaScript function that shows an alert with a message of your choice when the button is clicked. You can connect the button and function using the `onclick` attribute. Finally, in `styles.css`, style the button with a red background and white text.

After this step, clicking your button should show a custom alert message.

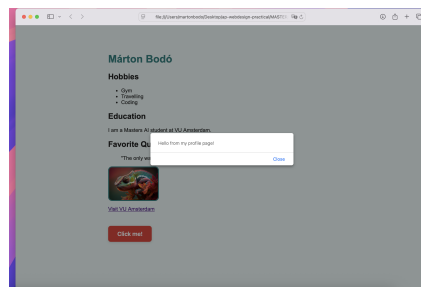


Figure 9: Step 9: The red alert button is displayed and shows a message when clicked.

Step 10: Make Your Name Bold and One Hobby Italic

Goal: Use HTML tags to make your name bold and to display one hobby in italics for emphasis.

Guidance: Open `index.html`. To make your name bold, use an appropriate HTML tag or style inside your name's `<h1>` element (your CSS from earlier steps may already make it bold, but try an HTML tag as well). Next, choose one of your hobbies in the list and use an HTML tag to display just that hobby in italics.

After this step, your name will appear bold, and one of your hobbies will stand out in italics.

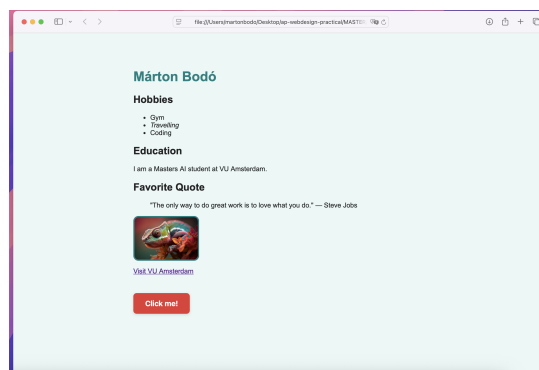


Figure 10: Step 10: The name is bold, and one hobby is italic.

Step 11: Add a CSS Class to Your Hobbies List and Change Text Color

Goal: Make your hobbies list stand out by giving each hobby a text color using CSS.

Guidance: In `index.html`, make sure your hobbies list or its items have a class name (such as `hobbies`). In `styles.css`, write a CSS rule for this class to set a new text color for your hobbies. You can use any color that fits your theme—try something different from the rest of your text so your hobbies are easy to spot.

After this step, your hobbies should be displayed in a unique color, different from your main text.

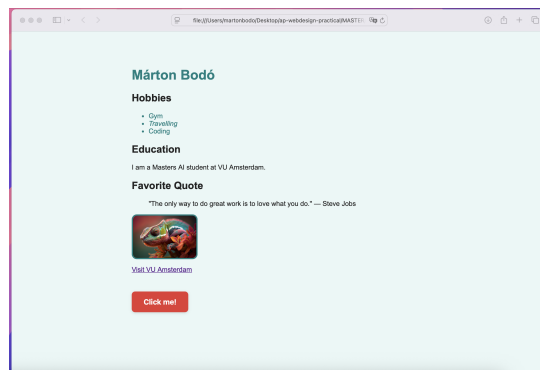


Figure 11: Step 11: The hobbies are now in a different text color.

Step 12: Center Your Name at the Top

Goal: Use CSS to center your name at the top of your profile page.

Guidance: In `styles.css`, find or add the selector for your name's element (with `id="name"`). Use a CSS property to make sure your name appears centered horizontally at the top of the page. Save your changes and refresh your browser to see the effect.

After this step, your name will be centered at the top of your profile page.

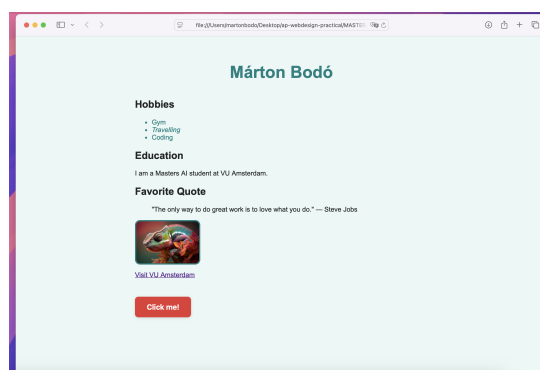


Figure 12: Step 12: The name is now centered at the top of the page.

Conclusion

Congratulations on completing your personal profile page! By working through each step, you've practiced the essential building blocks of web development: editing HTML, styling with CSS, and adding interactivity with JavaScript. These skills form a strong foundation not only for your main group project, but for all your future work in web-based applications and user interfaces. Remember, the best way to learn is through experimentation—so don't hesitate to keep refining your page or trying out new features. We hope you enjoyed this practical and feel more confident as you continue your journey in Applied Programming for AI.

We look forward to seeing your unique creations. Happy coding!